

IBM starts free quantum computing Cloud service

IBM has opened up access to a five-qubit quantum computing processor located in New York, USA, through a new free Cloud service. Qubit is the fundamental unit of quantum computing which, unlike bits in classical computing, can be zero or one or both. The system would let users run algorithms, experiments and simulations, and even work with individual qubits.

NI India expands R&D centre, launches business incubator program

National Instruments (NI) India has launched NI India Business Incubator Program and announced the expansion of their R&D centre in India. Both the initiatives aim to support Make in India programme and enable Indian engineers to become global knowledge partners in driving innovation and development across industries and domains.

EESL's reach to extend to the USA

Energy Efficient Services Ltd (EESL) is ready to set up an office in New York, USA. This government firm has already completed distribution of about 90 million LED bulbs under its domestic efficient lighting programme. It is now expected to share India's innovative ways of mainstreaming energy efficiency, primarily on the back of economies of scale and transparent procurement.

Goa to distribute 1.5 million LED bulbs

Goa Electricity Department is all set to distribute 1.5 million LED bulbs to 489,000 consumers to help the electricity department save up to 78.56 million units of power annually and help domestic consumers save power costs by up to ₹ 1100 per 1000 electricity units. This move will make it the first state in the country to have 100 per cent LED coverage.

diversify their product portfolios and strengthen their market position.

Punjab to get solar farm

Punjab State Power Corp. Ltd (PSPCL) has signed an agreement with the clean-energy wing of Hindustan Power to commission a 30MW solar farm in Mansa district. With a total investment of ₹ 2 billion, the solar farm is expected to power approximately 24,000 households per day.

Ratul Puri, chairman, Hindustan Power, said that India has begun its work to achieve a target of 175GW by 2022, and the commissioning of this 30MW solar farm is another significant step in this direction.

The project will feed 50 million units of clean energy annually to the 66kV grid and has the potential to turn farmers into green energy entrepreneurs.

Thermal power plant commissioned in Anuppur

Hindustan Power has commissioned the first phase (1.2GW) of the thermal power plant in Anuppur, Madhya Pradesh, at a cost of ₹ 80 billion. This is one of the first thermal plants in the country that is operating at 100 per cent capacity, and power from it has been available since the last five months. The plant is directly connected to the national grid/Inter State Transmission System (ISTS) to enhance its reliability, economy and to minimise system losses.

The plant is situated very close to the coal mines of South Eastern Coalfields Ltd and Coal India Ltd, making it very attractive to all stakeholders.

Coal for the project is secured through a fuel supply agreement with South Eastern Coalfields Ltd. The total capacity of the flagship thermal plant is 2.52GW, which is to be developed in two phases of 1.2GW (2 × 600MW) and 1.32GW (2 × 660MW), within a span of four years with an investment of ₹ 90 billion.

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Calendar of Forthcoming Electronics Fairs/Exhibitions/Seminars/Events

Name, Date and Venue	Topics	Contact address for details
IEEE International Conference on Power Electronics, Drives and Energy Systems December 14-17, 2016 Tiruvandur, India	The conference provides a platform for discussions, networking and publication of the benefits of power electronics and its allied technologies	Government Engineering College Thrissur Website: www.pedes2016.org
CES 2017 January 5-8, 2017 Las Vegas, Nevada, USA	Gathering place for those who thrive on the business of consumer technologies	Consumer Technology Association Website: www.ces.tech
India Electronics Week March 24, 2017 Bangalore International Exhibition Centre, Bengaluru	An exhibition for the global electronics industry showcasing concurrently six events: Electronics For You Expo, Electronics Rocks, T&M India, LED Asia, Raksha India and IoT Show	EFY Enterprises Pvt Ltd Phone: +91-11-42586605 Website: www.indiaelectronicsweek.com
ExpoElectronica April 25-17, 2017 Crocus Expo, Moscow, Russia	International exhibition of electronic components, modules and components	ExpoElectronica Website: www.expoelectronica.ru

Since this information is subject to change, all those interested are advised to ascertain the details from the organisers before making any commitment.

In the last one year, India has witnessed vast foreign as well as local investments in the electronics manufacturing domain, and this has led to the growth of the chipset market. It will be further propelled by more manufacturing opportunities in the country. North and south India are leading chipset growth, excelling primarily due to the kind of manufacturing investments in these two locations.

According to the report published by Reportlinker, computers, laptops, printers and peripheral chipsets are key application areas for chipsets in India. The report states that with robust growth in smartphone penetration across the country over the last few years, a growing number of computer and laptop chipset manufacturers are increasing their focus towards smartphone chipsets in order to